

The Practitioner's Kit

Hygiene, sanitation, and the discipline that must exist before a single brush touches a face

Learning Objectives

- Assemble a properly organised, sanitisable professional makeup kit
- Explain correct cleaning protocol for brushes and sponges between every client
- Identify products that must never be double-dipped or shared without a barrier method
- Explain the specific infection risks makeup tools carry, and how each is prevented

The kit is where trust is earned or lost

A makeup artist's tools sit closer to mucous membranes — the eyes, the lips — than almost any other beauty service touches. That proximity is precisely why this module exists, and why its discipline is never optional, however busy a bridal morning becomes.

The essential kit

- **Brushes** — a full set spanning foundation, powder, concealer, blending, and precision eye work, in sufficient quantity to rotate a clean set through a full day of clients.
- **Sponges** — reusable blending sponges alongside disposable options for any client requesting extra assurance.
- **Palettes and decanting tools** — small spatulas and disposable palettes for portioning cream and liquid products away from communal pots.
- **Single-use applicators** — disposable mascara wands, lip brushes, and eyeliner brushes, used once and discarded, never returned to a communal product.

- **A dedicated sanitising station** — brush cleanser, 70% isopropyl alcohol spray for quick between-client tool sanitising, and a clean towel supply.

Brush and sponge cleaning protocol

1. Between every client: spray brushes with a 70% alcohol solution and wipe on a clean cloth or tissue until no colour transfers.
2. Weekly (more often with heavy use): deep-clean all brushes and sponges with a gentle cleanser or dedicated brush soap, working the product into the bristles, rinsing until water runs clear, reshaping, and air-drying flat.
3. Sponges specifically: deep-clean after every single use where possible — their porous structure holds bacteria and product far more than a brush does.
4. Discard and replace brushes and sponges showing frayed bristles, persistent staining, or odour despite cleaning — these are signs the tool can no longer be fully sanitised.

Never double-dipped, never shared without a barrier

Any product a client's mouth or eye area contacts directly — lipstick applied straight from the bullet, mascara straight from the tube, a cream product scooped with a bare finger — must never go on to another client without an intervening barrier. Decant cream and liquid products onto a clean palette with a spatula. Dip mascara wands once, using a disposable wand for each client, or apply from a single-client-only tube. Sharpen lip and eye pencils before and after each use, which removes the outer, contact-exposed layer of the product entirely.

The specific risks this protocol prevents

- **Conjunctivitis and other eye infections** — spread readily through shared mascara and eyeliner.
- **Staphylococcus and other bacterial infections** — can transfer through unsanitised sponges and brushes onto broken or irritated skin.
- **Herpes simplex (cold sores)** — transmissible through shared lip products, as covered in Module Three.

None of these risks are rare or theoretical in an unsanitised kit. All of them are almost entirely preventable with the protocol above, applied without exception.

Key Terms

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Practical Activity · The Kit Build

Assemble your own working kit against this module's checklist, and demonstrate correct decanting technique for one cream product and one liquid product. **Photograph your organised kit — it becomes part of your capstone documentation.**